



SUBMITTED TO

Gong hiring team

Regional Vice President, Industry Expansion (Commercial and Mid-Market) search

Confidential — submitted in lieu of a candidate application

DATE

May 2026

Application: Hiring Diligence Partner

Submitted to Gong for a role no recruiter is paid to do — pre-offer diligence and post-hire validation on the Regional Vice President, Industry Expansion (Commercial and Mid-Market) search. One page, £2,000 pilot, free Week-1 audit.

The role you didn't post a partner for. Regional Vice President, Industry Expansion (Commercial and Mid-Market) at Gong is a hire that compounds the next eighteen months or costs you them. The posting opened 1 day ago based in Chicago | New York City | Salt Lake City. The recruiter on it is paid to close — their commercial interest ends at the signed offer. No one on the engagement is paid to surface why this candidate might be the wrong shape for the role, or to track whether they actually compound the team once they land. That gap is what this application is for.

The math. A search firm places the candidate. Spine evaluates whether they will work. On a £200k base, recruiter fees run **£50–66k**. Mis-hire cost — replacement, twelve months of lost output, opportunity cost — typically lands at **£500k to £2M**; a recent case Spine documented closed at **\$5.5M**. Spine's pilot is **£2,000**. Less than 5% of the search fee. Less than 0.5% of the downside that fee does not cover.

Week 1, free — Hire Risk Audit. A retrospective audit on a recent senior hire of Gong's, delivered as a one-page memo within five working days. Risk concentration in hindsight, scorecard, blind-spot map. No commercial commitment until Gong accepts the deliverable. The audit doesn't land — Gong keeps the memo and walks away. The audit lands — the pilot kicks in for the live Regional Vice President, Industry Expansion (Commercial and Mid-Market) search.

Week 2 → Day 90, £2,000 — full pilot. Pre-hire memo and scorecard before the offer is extended (risk concentration, blind spots, A-Player Probability range for this stage and role shape). Structured 60-day check-in tracking decision velocity, time to first verifiable outcome, and expectation drift. Day-90 binary recommendation — keep, expand, intervene, or replace. No placement fee. No recurring obligation. No procurement.

Three slots open. Spine is taking three pilot engagements through end of June 2026, filled in order received. Reply with the recent hire Gong would want audited and the Week-1 deliverable returns within five working days.

Submitted for Gong's consideration — no fee until the Week-1 audit lands.